

Assignment Brief: Infection Control Protocols & Personal Protection in Care Settings

Course/Module: Meet personal support needs

Assessment Weight: 100 Marks (100% of Assignment Grade)

Format: ShortEssay/Critical Responses

Expected Length: 300–450 words per question (3,000–4,500 words total)

Instructions to Students

This assignment requires you to critically evaluate contemporary frameworks in institutional care, ethics, law, and quality improvement. While these themes may have been introduced in course webinars, **every response must be grounded in independent external research.**

You must cite external literature, legal statutes, sociological concepts, or comparative international frameworks as specified in each prompt. Ensure all sources are correctly cited using the required academic referencing style (e.g., APA 7th Edition).

Question 1:

Explain the fundamental difference between standard precautions applied to all residents and transmission-based precautions (contact, droplet, airborne). Under what specific clinical indicators should a care worker initiate transmission-based precautions prior to receiving laboratory confirmation?

Question 2:

Detail the World Health Organization's "5 Moments for Hand Hygiene" within an aged care or residential setting. Why is performing hand hygiene after touching a resident's immediate surroundings just as critical as performing it after direct physical contact?

Question 3:

Outline the correct step-by-step sequence for donning (putting on) and doffing (taking off) a full suite of PPE (gown, mask/respirator, eye protection, gloves). Which specific stage of the doffing process carries the highest risk of self-contamination, and how must a care worker mitigate that risk?

Question 4:

Distinguish between a formal "fit-test" and a daily pre-use "fit-check" (seal check) for N95/P2 respirators. What physical factors or facial changes would require a care worker to undergo a mandatory repeat fit-test?

Question 5:

What is the distinction between cleaning (using detergent) and chemical disinfection? Why is strictly adhering to the manufacturer's specified "contact time" (wet dwell time) essential when applying hospital-grade disinfectants to high-touch surfaces?

Question 6:

When a respiratory or gastrointestinal outbreak occurs in a residential care facility, how can care staff enforce effective cohorting and isolation protocols while ensuring the resident's basic human rights, mobility, and psychological well-being are preserved?

Question 7:

Describe the correct safety protocols for handling and disposing of contaminated sharps (e.g., glucose testing lancets). What immediate post-exposure steps must a worker take if they sustain an accidental needle-stick injury or blood splash?

Question 8:

Unlike controlled facility environments, private homes present unpredictable hygiene conditions. How should a community care worker prepare their point-of-care kit, set up a clean working zone in a client's home, and safely dispose of contaminated PPE after a visit?

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Question 9:

What are a care worker's ethical and legal obligations regarding vaccination compliance and self-reporting infectious symptoms? What are the standard work exclusion periods for staff suffering from acute gastroenteritis or respiratory infections?

Question 10:

Explain the core principles of the Aseptic Non-Touch Technique (ANTT) during simple wound dressing changes or catheter care. How does maintaining "key sites" and "key parts" protected prevent healthcare-associated infections (HAIs)?

Marking Scheme & Grading Rubric (100 Marks Total)

Each of the 10 questions is worth **10 marks**, assessed against the following criteria:

High Distinction	9 - 10	Exceptional synthesis of external research. Argument is highly critical, nuanced, and perfectly directly addresses all parts of the prompt. Flawless referencing.
Distinction	7.5 - 8.5	Strong integration of external concepts. Solid analysis with clear logical flow. Minor gaps in depth or minor formatting issues.
Credit	6 - 7	Adequate research, though relies on basic definitions. Analysis is present but lacks critical depth or systemic insight. Competent writing and referencing.
Pass	5 - 5.5	Barely addresses the prompt. Heavy reliance on course materials rather than independent external research. Descriptive rather than analytical.
Fail	0 - 4.5	Fails to answer the prompt. Missing external research entirely. Poorly structured, lacking citations, or demonstrating fundamental misunderstandings of the topic.